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NO: 0898 , Monday, August 10, 2026



Real Times Digital Newspaper

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Voters card for salt?

...aspiring councillor, four others on the run after allegedly exchanging salt with voters' cards.

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Meal allowances: Private universities next, says HH

By Ruth Kambita

President Hakainde Hichilema says his government has plans to extend meal allowances, student advisories and other welfare measures to private universities and colleges.

He said the rollout began with public institutions but will be expanded because "a student in a public college is no different from a student in a private college."

Mr Hichilema also pledged to strengthen internship programmes to link students with companies from their second or third year, boosting post-graduation employment opportunities, and to reform education to support youth entrepreneurship, including backing graduates who start schools or clinics.

Speaking to thousands of students at State House in Lusaka today, he warned that the opposition Tonse Alliance includes former Patriotic Front



President Hakainde Hichilema addressing students from various institutions at State House in Lusaka today.

officials, who, he alleged, previously cut allowances and halted student hostels,

and cautioned that a change in government could reverse recent gains.

Thousands of students attended the event to thank the President for policies

such as free education and restored meal and accommodation allowances.

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Real News in Real Time

Voters card for salt?

By Alex Maboshe

Jackson Chilembo, an aspiring councillor for the NRPUP under the Tonse Alliance, together with four others is on the run for allegedly exchanging salt and cash for voters’ cards.

Eastern province commanding officer Robertson Mweemba confirmed the incident stating that it occurred on Saturday and was reported at Chama police station by 41 year old Jairos Mwandila resident and aspiring councillor for Sitwe Ward under the United Party for National Development (UPND).

According to Mr Mwandila, he received information from ward member Nyirenda Bozo that individuals were offering registered voters one kilogramme of coarse salt and K20 each in return for their Zambian voters’ cards.

Mwandila dispatched some members from the ruling party Gibson Mkandawire and Thomas Mukalama to verify the tip.

Upon arrival, they reportedly found Jackson Chilembo, together with Jacob Chilembo, Rabson Mukisi and a man identified only as Kamutowa, actively exchanging the salt and cash for voters’ cards.

The group had already distributed some packets and was found in possession of 31 remaining one-kilogramme packets of coarse salt.

Among those who had reportedly surrendered their cards were Sara Nyirenda, Justina Nyimbili, Alfred Nyimbili and Bozo Nyimbili.

A docket has been opened, but no arrests have been made as the suspects are said to be on the run.

Mr Mweemba stated that a manhunt has been instituted and further updates are expected as investigations continue.

‘Brace for coldest spell’

By Ruth Kambita

Zambia is set to endure its coldest and windiest stretch of the year from tomorrow, August 11, to 15, 2026, as a powerful high-pressure system funnels cool, moist air across the country, the Zambia Meteorological Department (ZMD) has warned.

The agency says the system, anchored over the Indian Ocean and southeast coast of South Africa, will drive strong gusts, lower temperatures and dusty conditions across Western, Lusaka, Central, Southern, Eastern and Muchinga provinces.

“Members of the public are advised to dress warmly, particularly during cooler nights and early mornings,” ZMD said in an advisory issued yesterday. “People with respiratory conditions, children and the elderly should limit exposure to dust and use appropriate protective

measures where necessary.”

The department also urged parents and guardians to closely supervise children and keep them away from open fires, braziers and other heating sources to prevent burn injuries; a timely warning as households turn to makeshift heating during cold snaps.

Water transport users have been told to exercise extreme caution or suspend operations on lakes and

rivers, where gusty winds could create hazardous conditions for small craft and ferries.

ZMD, under the Ministry of Green Economy and Environment, said it would continue monitoring weather patterns and issue updates in collaboration with the Disaster Risk Management Division as the cold wave unfolds.

Lusaka police take interest in Binwell Mpundu video clip

By Alex Maboshe

Police in Lusaka says it has taken special interest in the recent highly circulated video clip depicting former Nkana Member of Parliament Binwell Mpundu over his threats that he was ready to die or kill for the elections.

This comes in the wake of Democratic Advocates for Good Governance executive director, Fabian Mutale, who formally reported Mr Mpundu for action over his threats yesterday.

In the video, Mr Mpundu allegedly declared he is “ready to be killed and to kill” in the upcoming election, stating that a great deal is at stake for people like him and that he is prepared either to die or to kill.

Mutale described the comments as unacceptable and alarming, warning that they risk causing panic among citizens just days before Zambia’s general election.

“The video by Mr Mpundu brought fear in me. I became concerned that, in this era, we have people willing to sink so low as to wish to die or to kill just to secure a leadership position,” Mutale said.

He emphasised that leadership is about service and that voters should freely choose their leaders without any form of coercion.

“Politics should never be reduced to a matter of life and death,” he added.

Mr Mutale questioned the claim that “there is so much at stake in this election for some of us,” asking “What exactly is at stake? The people of Zambia deserve to know, and only the speaker can provide those answers.”

He urged police to investigate the matter thoroughly, noting that Mpundu spoke in the plural rather than the singular.

Zambia Police Service spokesperson Godfrey Chilabi confirmed that the police have taken an interest in the video.

Cyclist collides with pedestrian, dies

By Alex Maboshe

By Alex Maboshe
A 24-year-old cyclist has died following a collision with a pedestrian along the Great East Road near Old Welcome in Chipata District. The accident occurred on Saturday, 8 August 2026, at around 19:30 hours. Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba identified the deceased as Hope Zulu of Mchacha Village in Kasenengwa

District. According to Mr Mweemba, Zulu was riding an Eagle Gents bicycle from east to west when he allegedly lost control due to excessive speed and struck an unidentified pedestrian who was standing in the cycle path while holding a bicycle. The pedestrian fled the scene immediately after the impact. Zulu sustained severe head injuries and died at the scene. His body has been taken to Chipata Central Hospital mortuary, where it awaits a post-mortem examination. Police have opened investiga-

tions into the accident and are working to establish the identity and whereabouts of the pedestrian involved.

Findlay still missing

By Alex Maboshe

The whereabouts of businessman Harry Findlay remain unknown after he was allegedly taken from police custody and driven to an undisclosed location.

In a statement released today on Mr Findlay’s official Facebook page, the family said that at around 18:00 last evening he was driven away in an unmarked vehicle.

When relatives asked which institution was taking him, they received no answers and were threatened with arrest when they tried to follow. His location is still unknown.

Mr Findlay was arrested by Zambia Police on 4 August as earlier confirmed by police Spokesperson Godfrey Chilabi and has now spent six days in detention without a formal charge or any lawful extension of custody.

The family says any transfer to a maximum-security facility requires legal authority that has not been shown to them.

Authorities are aware of Mr Findlay’s medical condition and have been provided with his full medical history.

His prescription medication was left behind, and the family warns that missing daily doses poses an immediate risk to his life. Requests to deliver the medicine have gone unanswered.

Lawyers have been instructed to demand either his immediate release or that he be brought before a court.

“We ask that the law be applied to Mr Findlay as it applies to every Zambian,” the family said. “This is not a request for special treatment. It is a request for lawful treatment.”

The family has called on the authorities either to produce him in court without delay and state the legal basis for his detention, or to release him at once.

They stressed that constitutional protections for one citizen safeguard the liberty of all.

Namwala man murdered

By Alex Maboshe

A 22-year-old man’s body has been discovered with visible injuries in the Busangu Plains of Mungaila Chiefdom in Namwala District.

Southern Province Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo confirmed the matter stating that Ms. Munye Shiluwe, 68, of Maala Area in Mungaila Chiefdom, reported the matter to Namwala Police Station on August 8, 2026, at 15:00 hours.

According to the report, Ms Shiluwe stated that her son, Castrol Lwiinda, had allegedly been murdered by unknown persons.

Police say the incident is believed to have occurred between approximately 15:00 hours on August 6 and 11:00 hours on August 8 at the Busangu Area.

Mr. Moono revealed that Lwiinda and his nephew had been assigned to look after cattle at the Busangu Plains grazing area.

On August 6 around 15:00 hours, the two went to the Kafue River crossing point known as Mulandu wabusangu, where they interacted with neighbouring herdsmen.

Lwiinda reportedly later told his colleagues he was returning to the camp and left the area and his nephew remained behind.

“Around 18:00 hours, the nephew collected the cattle from the grazing area and returned them to the camp,” Mr. Namalongo said.

“Upon arrival, he did not find Lwiinda. He waited, but the young man did not return. The following day, August 7, around 14:30 hours, the nephew contacted a family member to check whether Lwiinda had gone home.”

“After learning he had not, other relatives were notified and a search began. On August 8 around 11:00 hours, searchers found Lwiinda’s body lying face down in the plains.”

The body showed a swollen and bleeding right eye, a cut on the upper lip, and bleeding from the genital area.

Police inspected the body, confirmed the injuries, and later deposited it at Namwala District Hospital mortuary pending a postmortem examination to determine the cause of death.

A case docket has been opened. No arrests have been made.

Investigations are ongoing to establish the full circumstances of the death, identify those responsible, and bring them to justice.

The Zambia Police Service has appealed to members of the public with any information that could assist the investigation to report it to the nearest police station.

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‘Violent individuals may not vote’

By Linda Nyondo

The Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) says it will not overstretch its boundaries to have alleged perpetrators of violence released from detention for them to cast their votes.

ECZ chief Electoral Officer Brown Kasaro says it is beyond the Commission’s jurisdiction to ensure that persons accused of perpetrating violence during elections and are detained exercise their right to vote.

“The law is clear on offenses.

We cannot interfere with persons who have been detained for coming into conflict with the law,” he says.

Mr Kasaro Officer added that doing anything outside the confines of the law will be overstretching their boundaries.

Mr Kasaro says the Commission will execute its duties within the confines of the law.

The Commission has committed to begin announcing election results within 72 hours of closing the polling station.

Mr Kasaro also said that representatives from all sectors of society including persons with disabilities have been included in the Electoral process.

Earlier, ECZ Chairperson Mwangala Zaloumis said that the presence of independent electoral observers at polling stations is important and appreciated at the same time.

“Your presence at polling stations provides an opportunity to independently carry out your monitoring activities,” she says.

Ms Zaloumis has however cautioned monitors not to overstretch and interfere with the work of polling staff.

She says both local and international observers must conduct themselves within the confines of the law.



The signing ceremony for the Twin Palm Water Supply Improvement Project between LWSC, NAPSA and ZAF in Lusaka today in pictures.



HAMAUNDU

No breach of timetable, Kawana warns

The Permanent Secretary at the Ministry of Information and Media, Thabo Kawana, has warned political parties and their supporters against incitement to violence and said breaches of the agreed campaign timetable will not be tolerated ahead of the 2026 general election.

Mr Kawana condemned remarks from some quarters that could encourage supporters “to kill or be killed” over election disputes, and urged that the polls be treated as a contest of ideas rather than a matter of life and death.

He called on all political actors to respect peace and adhere to the agreed campaign schedule, noting that the 2026 election is neither the first nor the last and must be conducted calmly.

“We appeal to all parties and candidates, regardless of affiliation, to comply with the agreed programme,” he said, specifically naming the UPND, Heritage Party, Republican Party, UNIP, MMD and NRPUP, and stressing that the timetable applies equally to every registered party.

Mr Kawana also urged law enforcement agencies to act against individuals who incite violence, and appealed to citizens not to respond to calls for attacks based on political differences.

ZAF, NAPSA sign K150m water project

By Ruth Kambita

The Zambia Air Force (ZAF) and the National Pension Scheme Authority (NAPSA) yesterday signed a K150 million contract to build a 12-kilometre pipeline that will supply water to more than 25,000 residents in the Twin Palm and Ibex Hill areas.

Under the Bulk Water Supply Project, ZAF and NAPSA will fund the works while the Lusaka Water Supply and Sanitation Company (LWSC) will construct and operate the pipeline over an 18-month

period. The project also includes a booster station, a groundwater reservoir and management infrastructure.

Ministry of Defence Permanent Secretary Maambo Haamaundu said the initiative reflects the New Dawn Government’s commitment to expanding infrastructure and ensuring access to essential services.

“When communities have access to clean water, diseases reduce, households become productive and communities get empowered,” he said after witnessing the signing at Air Force Headquarters.

ZAF Commander Lt Gen Oscar Nyoni thanked President

Hakainde Hichilema and the government for continued support, saying the project will boost morale and operational readiness among personnel.

NAPSA Acting Director-General Joshua Malipenga said the investment will deliver sustainable development to Queensland Park, ZAF Twin Palm, Da Tong and other nearby settlements.

LWSC Managing Director Jilly Chiyombwe pledged to deliver the works with “quality, professionalism and transparency,” adding that the rapidly growing Twin Palm and Ibex areas require increased water capacity to support development and commerce.



FIFA president Gianni Infantino was first elected in 2016.

Infantino broke trust ‘through deception’ - confederation presidents

Nkana prodigy Chuma wins Chick ‘O’ North golf crown

By Benedict Tembo

Nkana Golf Academy member Emmanuel Chuma last weekend announced his arrival on the local scene by winning the prestigious Chick ‘O’ North junior competition in Kitwe.

The 16-year-old prodigy, a grade 12 at Nkana Secondary School in Kitwe shot 7 over gross after 36 holes.

Chuma, the younger brother of Zambia’s elite amateur golfer, Michael, was among the 25 boys and girls the host club entered in the country’s top juniors competitions sanctioned by the Zambia Golf Union (ZGU).

While Chuma took the first place, Abel Mwendapole of Chilanga Golf Club took the second place.

In the two-day tournament dominated by golfers from the host club, Elijah Musukwa and Frank Manda both of Nkana tied in third position.

Elijah Kamalamba, also of Nkana, finished fourth.

Harrison Lungu, 13, was youngest player.

Lungu played 18 holes and won the first position.

Fifa and its president Gianni Infantino have been accused of breaking trust “through deception” in an open letter issued by Uefa, Concacaf and the Asian Football Confederation.

The letter, signed by the presidents and general secretaries of the three regional governing bodies, said recent controversy over the Fifa Forward Enterprise (FFE) proposal was fundamentally about “the integrity of the game, and the integrity of those elected to lead it”.

FFE would have meant a new company being created to manage commercial and ticketing rights of all Fifa competitions, including the World Cups, with 21% sold off to a private investment company.

It was aborted after widespread criticism from several confederations, led by Uefa which has threatened a boycott of all Fifa competitions.

BBC Sport understands that there have been preliminary discussions between the three confederations over breakaway competitions - should Infantino remain in situ. However, substantive talks are yet to begin, according to others.

“When trust is broken through deception, when an individual places himself above the

collective that entrusted him with authority, that duty has been abandoned,” the letter read.

It added: “Leadership in football is not a possession. It is not about holding - or demanding - power to be held. It is a duty of service to the football family that entrusts it.”

While the statement did not name Infantino, sources have told BBC Sport that it should be seen as an opportunity for him to resign and leave his position with dignity.

It comes after Fifa issued a statement on Saturday evening which strongly criticised a “concerted and ongoing effort” to “undermine” the organisation and Infantino.

‘Proposal inherently wrong... a profound failure of judgement’

The three confederations - representing Europe, North America, Central America and the Caribbean, and Asia - released a statement after Infantino called management board members to a meeting in Rabat, Morocco last Wednesday.

The confederations cited Infantino shutting out Fifa council members and member associations from the meeting, instead

summoning only Fifa-employed senior staff.

The open letter added that Fifa’s admission of mistakes made in the FFE process did not go far enough.

“It did not acknowledge that the proposal itself was inherently wrong,” the letter stated. “There remains no recognition that attempting to sell an interest in the Fifa World Cup was a profound failure of judgement.

“Not just a procedural misstep, but a fundamental breach of trust with the very institutions Fifa exists to serve.”

Fifa has committed to presenting a report to the next meeting of the Fifa council, which is expected to take place in October.

But the three confederations said this failed to “recognise that proper governance in the face of such a profound lack of judgement would require that such a review be conducted by a fully independent third party”.

Their letter added: “There is silence where there should be accountability, distance where there should be openness.”

It also underlined a legal warning made by Uefa that Fifa should not delete or destroy any documents related to the abandoned plans.-BBC